

A. K. ANTONY

Minister of Defence

Slow but Steady

It seems odd that this quiet and non-confrontist Keralite was given the charge of the country's defence. But the pacifist in the dhoti-clad minister betrays a steely determination. He may have been in and out of the Congress more than once, but is now part of the 'gang of four' that advises Sonia Gandhi.

Achievement

Pushing through the largest expansion of the Indian Army in more than 25 years. Two mountain warfare divisions with 30,000 troops each and another two are in the pipeline. It's all part of his quiet strategy to deter China.

Failures

Lack of strategic vision and inability to conduct a security dialogue on issues beyond obvious ones like transparency and procurement.

Unimplemented defence reforms are piling up as are modernisation delays.

Marquee Moment

Drew the line when former army chief Deepak Kapoor tried to protect a tainted aide. Among the few times when Mr Clean flared up.

▼ 38%



ANAND SHARMA

Minister of Commerce and Industry

Breaking Barriers

The elevation of the minister of state for external affairs and information and broadcasting in the UPA I as the Cabinet minister for commerce and industry did cause much heartburn. But a year into his job, Sharma has proved his worth by driving India's global trade negotiations and fine-tuning the FDI policy. His networking skills and persuasive style have helped India shed the tag of deal-breaker.



Achievement

I Took over at the peak of the global meltdown when exports fell 40 per cent. A year into office, he made exports surge by 54 per cent. Last year, India got FDI worth \$35 billion when UNCTAD had predicted 40 per cent fall.

The Big Goal

I A number fetish for 41. That's the number of new markets in Africa, Asia and Latin America that he is scouting for as part of his foreign trade policy. Working on raising India's share of world trade, now just 1.5 per cent.

Power Statement

When Manmohan Singh's entourage was held up in Brazil because of volcanic ash in Europe, he approached South African President Jacob Zuma. The prime minister returned to Delhi via Johannesburg.

▼ 61%

S.M. KRISHNA

Minister of External Affairs

Style and Substance

S.M. Krishna was enjoying a post-retirement sinecure at the Mumbai Raj Bhavan which included a couple of sets of tennis every evening when South Block beckoned. His was an initiation by fire, having had to defend the infamous Sharm-el-Sheikh joint statement in Parliament. But a year later, he appears to be in control of the foreign policy apparatus.

Style Statement

In the highbrow world of diplomacy, he fits like a T. Has a sharp dress sense, with Cartier glasses, designer ties and self-designed suits.

